

Kristen Mills

Software Engineer

🏠 knm.dev
🌐 @kristenmills
✉ kristen@knm.dev
📄 millsk91

Summary

Experienced software engineer with over a decade of professional experience across the stack based in Seattle, WA.

Work Experience

Heard

Senior Software Engineer

Seattle, WA

April 2025 - April 2026

Senior Software Engineer on the core engineering team at Heard, responsible for several efforts across the stack:

- Owned autorecon improvement efforts to increase accuracy and expand user eligibility. Brainstormed and proposed various improvements, evaluated potential impact and complexity, and implemented the most impactful improvements.
- Built the initial prototype for the Heard banking experience. Evaluated and scoped the effort to build out the full experience, working with design, product and biz ops, and served as a resource and technical lead for the engineers building out the full experience.
- Helped build out new pages and experiences for the 2026 tax season. This included building out new pages and flows for customers, helping our support and bookkeeping teams with issues that may arise for customers, and helping prioritize the most impactful work for the engineering team to focus on during the tax season.
- Streamlined our Plaid account connection flow during onboarding, improving the customer experience and increasing the percentage of customers that successfully connect their accounts.
- Built out our affiliate integration in our application, allowing us to track and attribute customers who come to us through our affiliate partners.

Found

Staff Software Engineer

Seattle, WA

September 2022 - July 2024

Staff Engineer on the core banking team at Found, responsible for several different efforts:

- Tech lead for a large-scale migration to a new card issuer. I was responsible for architecting, designing, and implementing our new systems for creating, managing, and shipping new debit cards. This was a multi-quarter, cross-functional project that required working with multiple internal and external stakeholders. Additionally, I maintained these systems post-launch.
- Tech lead and domain expert for card shipping at the company. Championed and designed new systems to improve reliability of our card shipping flows, and was responsible for working with engineering team leads and other card shipping stakeholders to task out and prioritize this work across the engineering teams at the company.
- Built and supported various money movements including incoming wires, check depositing, and incoming and outgoing ACH.
- Built core features including templating flows for creating pockets and our automated account reopening flow.
- Helped improve code quality around our applications, defining best practices for using Spanner in our application and defining the patterns for modularizing our code.
- Supported mid-level and senior engineers on the team, ramping them up on team processes as well as providing mentorship as needed.

Superhuman

Senior Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA

July 2020 - November 2021

Senior Engineer on the 4-person backend engineering team at Superhuman. I worked on building the backend for the core features of the Superhuman Mail client, as well as maintaining and supporting our backend infrastructure and internal tooling.

- Led a project to add functionality for our delight team to be able to restore drafts for customers, improving the customer experience and saving time for the delight team.
- Tech lead for our Superhuman for teams experience, a feature that allows for customers to consolidate their billing under one account.
- Led the effort to support email sending in Superhuman for O365, designing and building that system.
- Led various reliability efforts around improving notification delivery as well as rethinking our metrics pipeline.

Postmates

Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA

Feb 2017 - Oct 2019

Frontend Web Engineer on the Growth team, then Fullstack/Backend Engineer on our Consumer Applications team, I worked on several different efforts:

- Rebuilt the postmates.com web app from the ground up. Key contributions include the homepage, merchant page and the checkout experience as well as creating the plan and executing the actual launch and migration to the new web app. I also started the effort of moving our team from JavaScript to TypeScript.
- Built and maintained our initial server-side rendering flow in the new web application, significantly decreasing initial render time for high traffic pages.
- Worked on backend services for various features including web push notifications, customer default settings, place availability notifications.
- Contributed core features to our in-house document store including support for ACID transactions and composite indexes. While this was a good learning experience, once I became lead engineer on the project, I chose to migrate us to Google Datastore and Cloud Bigtable and led that effort and maintenance going forward.
- Built several offline data processing jobs in Scala and Apache Beam for various features such as place tagging, sitemaps, and our Google Ordering partnership, which grew to generate an incremental \$72 million in yearly revenue.
- Designed and implemented a new solution for storing and maintaining carts.
- Maintained our team's Terraform configs, Kubernetes deployments, and CI/CD workflows.
- Led efforts on improving developer experience and enforcing best practices in our Go applications.
- Provided technical leadership to the web team, as well as mentoring junior and mid-level engineers across the stack.

Work Experience

Amazon

Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer

Jan 2016 - Jan 2017

Engineer on the Follows Team, which is responsible for the follow button and backing services that allow customers to follow entities (Authors, Brands, Customers, etc.) on Amazon and receive updates on the entities they follow, as well as providing recommendations on entities to follow. My contributions included:

- Built the recommendation tooltip frontend and backend and started the initial work on the recommendation page, introducing the team to React and setting up the initial infrastructure for that effort.
- Built a feature for sending email notifications when authors followed by customers published new releases.

Software Development Engineer Intern

June - Aug 2014

Intern on the Item Data Quality team, which is responsible for the accuracy and quality of data collected on item dimensions in the fulfillment center. I created a new troubleshooting internal tool that allowed for self-service handling of incorrect data gathered. Resolving these issues used to be a manual task that had to be done by our team's on-call engineer so this significantly reduced our team's ops burden and number of incoming tickets each week.

Open Source

Flexget

 <https://github.com/flexget>

Media automation tool, I am a contributor to the core Python application as well as the primary maintainer of the React/TypeScript Web UI.

Technologies

Languages: Go, Ruby, TypeScript/JavaScript/Node.js, Scala, Python, Nginx

Frameworks: Rails, React/Redux, GraphQL, Django, Apache Beam, Sidekiq, Temporal

Databases: Bigtable, MySQL, Spanner, Redis, Google Datastore/Firestore, BigQuery, Postgres, etcd, Memcached

Infra Tooling/DevOps: Kubernetes, Datadog, Docker, Google Cloud Platform, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology

Class of 2016

BS, Software Engineering. Minors in Applied Mathematics and Computer Science

Full work history available on LinkedIn